countries. They should go there. The Muslim countries will take care of them. They should go to countries with the same religion'.[27]

The monks organised in conjunction with the RNDP,[28] led by Aye Maung, and cooperated with other local political parties and community groups.[29] The RNDP seems to have been the driving force calling for the Rohingyas to be 'temporarily' relocated so that they would not live near the Rakhine, before being transferred to neighbouring countries. The RNDP even attacked those members of its own Rakhine community who continued to deal with the Rohingyas[30] and stoked fear that the Rohingyas, in league with Al-Qaeda, planned to massacre the Buddhist majority. These claims were supplemented with rumours that arms and ammunition were being stored in mosques and that the regime was too scared to protect the local community.[31] These arguments became widely believed among the Rakhine and were also broadcast on state-controlled radio.[32]

Social media has become important in Burma and forms a major source of information for many. Many stories start as social media reports and are then subsequently reported in the print media.[33] Thus hatred is stirred up online and then repeated by the press. One unedifying example of this comes directly from the top, from the director of President Sein's office, who posted on his Facebook page:

> It is heard that Rohingya Terrorists of the so-called Rohingya Solidarity Organization are crossing the border and getting into the country with the weapons. That is Rohingyas from other countries are coming into the country. Since our Military has got the news in advance, we will eradicate them until the end! I believe we are already doing it. … We don't want to hear any humanitarian issues or human rights from others. Besides, we neither want to hear any talk of justice nor want anyone to teach us like a saint.[34]

The post has since been deleted but screenshots have been preserved of the original. What followed was not the type of response one would expect of a saint, of any religious denomination. One set of triggers for the October violence was widely believed reports that three Buddhists had been killed by Muslims and two Burmese soldiers injured by gunfire.[35] But mainly the violence was a consequence of the deliberate actions and planning of the extremist monks and political parties such as the RNDP,[36] which had worked to break any remaining links between the Rohingya and Rakhine communities.